

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Automotive Service English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Service reception staff, service advisors, automotive technicians, parts-counter staff, and workshop assistants.

All vehicles, people, prices, incidents, findings, and shop arrangements are fictional English practice, not automotive diagnosis, repair instruction, driving advice, legal advice, or financial guidance. No script establishes vehicle safety or universal rights, charges, warranty terms, or authorization rules. Refer technical assessments, safe-use questions, hazardous conditions, pricing decisions, warranty coverage, and release requirements to the responsible qualified people and applicable local arrangements.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Capturing the customer's concern

Clarify vehicle identity and reported circumstances.

02 Clarifying the appointment and drop-off

Correct a booking assumption before the customer relies on it.

03 Explaining estimates and approval limits

Check what 'go ahead' actually authorizes.

04 Handing the concern to the technician

Give a technician a usable handoff without inserting a diagnosis.

05 Explaining parts and completion delays

Give parts status without turning a supplier estimate into a collection promise.

06 Relaying findings and technical terms

Explain technical terms and the limits of a technician's stated findings.

07 Clarifying the invoice and collection handoff

Clarify charge categories and separate billing from vehicle release.

08 Handling a repeat concern and follow-up

Acknowledge the customer's report and repair an unsupported claim.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Capturing the customer's concern

Clarify vehicle identity and reported circumstances.

SITUATION

Customer reports an occasional rattle from the rear after the car has been parked overnight. They do not know its cause. Two household cars are on the account; today's booking is the blue hatchback. No technician assessment has occurred.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

repair order - The job record linking a vehicle, customer concern, agreed work, and service results.

intermittent concern - A reported problem that occurs sometimes rather than continuously.

symptom description - The customer's account of what they noticed, without a confirmed explanation of cause.

vehicle identification number - The vehicle's unique identifying code, commonly shortened to VIN.

Useful word combinations

record the customer's words: preserve what was actually reported

clarify when it happens: ask about the reported circumstances

verify the vehicle identity: match the booking to the right vehicle

separate symptom from diagnosis: distinguish experience from technical explanation

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Record the concern without rewriting it as a diagnosis

3. Notice the language

Customer descriptions guide the handoff but do not establish a mechanical cause.

Which vehicle does this concern relate to?

You notice ___ when ___; is that accurate?

I'll record ___ as reported, with the cause unconfirmed.

Compare this wording: Your rear suspension is broken.

Clearer: You report an occasional rear rattle after overnight parking; the cause is unconfirmed.

The revised description preserves the symptom without inventing a fault.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: It happens some mornings, but not every time.

Advisor: I'll describe the concern as ____.

- A. continuous
- B. intermittent
- C. resolved
- D. reproduced

2. Customer: The blue hatchback rattles; the other car on the account does not.

Advisor: I'll add your report to the hatchback's ____, without recording a confirmed fault.

- A. completed inspection finding
- B. approved repair scope
- C. parts replacement request
- D. current repair order

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two cars, one reported rattle

At reception, an advisor clarifies the customer's vehicle and concern.

01 • Advisor: Which car is today's concern about, the blue hatchback or your white sedan?

02 • Customer: The blue hatchback. I sometimes hear a rattle from the rear after overnight parking.

03 • Advisor: Does it happen every morning, or only occasionally when you first notice it?

04 • Customer: Only occasionally. I can't identify a component, and I haven't noticed a consistent pattern.

05 • Advisor: I'll record an intermittent concern, with your rear-rattle description and the overnight-parking detail.

06 • Customer: Please don't call it a suspension fault. That was just someone's suggestion online.

07 • Advisor: I won't. We need the technician's assessment before naming a cause on the repair order.

08 • Customer: Can you make sure the account's other car doesn't inherit this concern too?

09 • Advisor: Yes. We'll verify the vehicle identification number against this booking and vehicle record.

10 • Customer: Thank you. That keeps my symptom description attached to the car actually being assessed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The sound word needs clarification

An advisor asks a customer to clarify an informal noise description.

01 • Customer: I wrote clicking on the booking, but rattling might describe the sound better.

02 • Advisor: Could you describe what you noticed without worrying about choosing a technical word?

03 • Customer: It was several quick little sounds, not one loud impact, near the passenger side.

04 • Advisor: I'll preserve that description rather than translate it into a component diagnosis.

05 • Customer: Please say it was my impression of the location, not something I verified.

06 • Advisor: Certainly. I'll mark passenger side as reported, with the exact source unconfirmed.

07 • Customer: Does changing my word from clicking to rattling mean the booking needs canceling?

08 • Advisor: No. We can clarify the concern on the existing repair order for this vehicle.

09 • Customer: Then include both my earlier wording and the clearer description we're discussing now.

10 • Advisor: I will. The technician can see how your description was clarified at intake.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Yesterday is not every day

An advisor checks the timing of a customer's concern.

01 • Advisor: The booking says the display goes blank daily. Is that frequency accurate?

02 • Customer: No. It happened yesterday once; I don't know why I selected daily online.

03 • Advisor: Thanks for correcting it. Had you noticed the same display issue before yesterday?

04 • Customer: Not that I remember. I don't want to claim it has never happened.

05 • Advisor: I'll record one episode reported yesterday, with no earlier episode recalled by you.

06 • Customer: That sounds right. Can the technician see that I corrected the original frequency?

07 • Advisor: Yes. I'll clarify the intake record so daily isn't treated as confirmed history.

08 • Customer: Please also distinguish the display from the whole electrical system. I can't assess that.

09 • Advisor: Agreed. Your report concerns the display only, and the cause remains unconfirmed.

10 • Customer: Then the symptom description now reflects what I actually observed rather than assumptions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Capturing the customer's concern

Customer reports an occasional rattle from the rear after the car has been parked overnight. They do not know its cause. Two household cars are on the account; today's booking is the blue hatchback. No technician assessment has occurred.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: the blue hatchback rattles on some mornings after overnight parking; you cannot identify a component.

Second round: Customer suggests a component name from an online video. Record it as their suggestion, not a diagnosis.

Scenario 2 | A relative's report

Customer booked a visit for a concern their partner noticed once on Monday. Customer has not experienced it personally; partner can provide details after 16:00.

Role A: Advisor: attribute the report and confirm who can clarify it.

Role B: Customer: distinguish your knowledge from your partner's experience.

Possible opening: Did you notice this yourself, or are you relaying your partner's account?

Success checks

- Attribute the Monday report.
- Avoid inventing frequency.
- Identify the partner's available contact time.

Add a complication: Customer asks you to record it as happening every trip.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying the appointment and drop-off

Correct a booking assumption before the customer relies on it.

SITUATION

Customer booked an 08:00 drop-off but expects work to begin at 08:00 and finish by 09:00. The booking confirms intake only. Advisor can offer a status update by 10:00, not a finish guarantee; customer prefers a phone call.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

drop-off appointment - A booking in which the customer leaves the vehicle rather than waiting throughout the visit.

waiting appointment - A booking arranged around the customer's plan to remain at the service location, without automatically guaranteeing completion time.

intake check - The reception-stage confirmation of the vehicle, concern, and agreed service arrangements.

contact preference - The customer's stated channel and availability for service communications.

Useful word combinations

confirm the appointment type: distinguish drop-off from waiting

set a callback window: agree when communication is expected

verify the contact preference: check channel and availability

clarify the intake check: separate reception from technician work

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Distinguish reception timing from completion timing

3. Notice the language

A booking time can identify intake rather than the start of technical work.

___ is the drop-off time, not ___.

We can update you by ___ about ___.

Would you prefer contact by ___?

Compare this wording: Eight means we'll start then.

Clearer: Eight is intake; a technician start time has not been confirmed.

The revision explains exactly what the appointment establishes.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Does eight o'clock guarantee work starts then?

Advisor: It confirms ___, not a technician start.

A. diagnosis

B. drop-off intake

C. parts arrival

D. repair completion

2. Customer: Please call rather than text, but I haven't approved any repair.

Advisor: I'll record your ___, leaving work authorization unchanged.

A. completion requirement

B. assessment finding

C. contact preference

D. repair decision

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Eight is the drop-off time

An advisor clarifies an 08:00 booking before the customer leaves.

01 • Customer: My appointment is eight, so I expected the car finished by nine today.

02 • Advisor: Eight is your drop-off intake, not a confirmed technician start or completion time.

03 • Customer: I misunderstood. I booked a ride based on having the car back within an hour.

04 • Advisor: I'm sorry the timing wasn't clear. We can provide a phone update by ten.

05 • Customer: Will that call tell me the assessment status, or guarantee the work is finished?

06 • Advisor: It will give the actual status. It isn't a promise of completion by ten.

07 • Customer: Please call rather than text. I can answer at the number on my booking.

08 • Advisor: I've confirmed that contact preference. Is the revised timing clear before you decide?

09 • Customer: Yes. I understand the drop-off appointment and the callback, but no finish time is guaranteed.

10 • Advisor: That's the arrangement. We'll keep any later completion estimate separate from the intake time.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Waiting does not settle the finish time

A customer asks reception about remaining at the shop.

01 • Customer: I selected a waiting appointment. Does that mean you'll finish before my eleven-o'clock meeting?

02 • Receptionist: The booking records your plan to wait, but no eleven-o'clock completion is confirmed.

03 • Customer: I need to know that now rather than discover it after the intake check.

04 • Receptionist: Of course. I can ask the service advisor to review timing before you proceed.

05 • Customer: Please tell them the meeting is fixed, but I can choose another appointment.

06 • Receptionist: I'll give them that constraint and request available alternatives, not cancel this booking automatically.

07 • Customer: Could the advisor explain whether leaving the vehicle would change the timing estimate?

08 • Receptionist: Yes. That is a scheduling question for them; I can't guarantee a faster result.

09 • Customer: Then I'll wait for that explanation before deciding whether to keep today's appointment.

10 • Receptionist: I'll connect you now, with the current booking and your meeting time clearly stated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A text cannot reach the customer

An advisor verifies a callback arrangement at drop-off.

01 • Advisor: Your booking lists text messages as the preferred contact method for today's updates.

02 • Customer: That number belongs to an old phone. Please use a call to my current number.

03 • Advisor: Let's confirm the current number through our booking check before changing the contact record.

04 • Customer: Certainly. I also can't answer between one and two because I'm presenting at work.

05 • Advisor: I'll record that availability limit alongside your preference for a phone call today.

06 • Customer: Does giving a new number authorize additional work if someone reaches me there?

07 • Advisor: No. Contact details only arrange communication; any work decision needs its own clear confirmation.

08 • Customer: Thank you. Please make that distinction if another advisor takes over this afternoon.

09 • Advisor: I'll include the verified number, call preference, and unavailable period in the handoff.

10 • Customer: Then the next advisor can reach me without assuming my contact update approves repairs.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying the appointment and drop-off

Customer booked an 08:00 drop-off but expects work to begin at 08:00 and finish by 09:00. The booking confirms intake only. Advisor can offer a status update by 10:00, not a finish guarantee; customer prefers a phone call.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you need a realistic update and prefer a phone call; nine was your assumption.

Second round: Customer asks whether a waiting appointment would guarantee a one-hour visit. Do not infer an unconfirmed finish time.

Scenario 2 | A revised drop-off message

Original booking: 09:00. A reminder says 09:30; office record has not been checked. Customer asks whether the later time replaces the earlier one.

Role A: Receptionist: compare message dates and request booking confirmation.

Role B: Customer: provide both messages; don't cancel either time yourself.

Possible opening: Which message is the current booking confirmation?

Success checks

- Identify the two times.
- Ask the booking desk to resolve them.
- Do not invent a technician start or finish time.

Add a complication: Customer treats the most recent automated message as guaranteed correct.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining estimates and approval limits

Check what 'go ahead' actually authorizes.

SITUATION

Fictional shop offers assessment for \$95 under its stated booking terms. No repair is included. Customer says 'go ahead' but intends only the assessment. Advisor must read back the scope and route any later repair proposal for separate approval.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

estimate - A stated anticipated cost for a defined service scope, subject to its expressed terms.

diagnostic charge - A charge for agreed assessment work, distinct from charges for any later repair.

authorization limit - The stated amount or scope a customer has agreed may proceed under the applicable service arrangement.

additional work - Work beyond the currently agreed scope that requires its own clarification and approval.

Useful word combinations

explain the estimate scope: identify the work a stated amount covers

confirm the authorization limit: repeat the customer's agreed boundary

request approval for additional work: seek a decision on a defined proposal

distinguish assessment from repair: name what the current charge covers

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Attach approval to a defined scope

3. Notice the language

An amount without a task description can be misunderstood. This fictional arrangement is not a universal rule about charges or approval.

Your approval covers ___ for ___, correct?

That does not include ___.

Any proposed additional work needs ___.

Compare this wording: You said go ahead, so everything is approved.

Clearer: You approved the stated assessment only; repairs would need a separate decision.

The read-back ties agreement to the customer's intended scope.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: I approve the assessment, not a repair.

Advisor: I'll keep the authorization ___ to that scope.

A. converted

B. limited

C. extended

D. unrelated

2. Customer: Does the diagnostic charge cover all repairs?

Advisor: In this booking it covers the ___ only.

A. completed repair

B. assessment

C. replacement

D. installation

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ninety-five dollars for assessment only

An advisor reads back a fictional shop's assessment terms.

01 • Customer: Ninety-five dollars is fine. Go ahead with the assessment, but not a repair.

02 • Advisor: To confirm, your approval covers the stated ninety-five-dollar assessment only under this booking.

03 • Customer: Yes. I want to hear any findings and proposed repair price before deciding.

04 • Advisor: I'll preserve that authorization limit. Additional work would need a separate discussion and decision.

05 • Customer: Does saying go ahead mean the technician can add other work up to that amount?

06 • Advisor: No. Your approval names the assessment scope, not any task costing less than ninety-five.

07 • Customer: Thank you. Please explain that distinction on the repair order for the technician.

08 • Advisor: I will. The diagnostic charge and any later repair proposal will remain separate.

09 • Customer: And the amount you stated applies to this particular assessment, not every service visit?

10 • Advisor: Correct. These are this booking's stated terms; other service scopes have their own terms.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Approval for one proposed item

A customer clarifies a decision after receiving two service proposals.

01 • Advisor: The technician's report includes two proposals, listed separately as item A and item B.

02 • Customer: I approve item A under the quoted terms, but I haven't decided about B.

03 • Advisor: Then I'll record approval for A only, with B awaiting your separate decision.

04 • Customer: Please don't mark the whole estimate approved just because I accepted one line.

05 • Advisor: I won't. Each proposal needs to retain its actual approval status on this record.

06 • Customer: Can I ask more questions about B without that being treated as permission?

07 • Advisor: Yes. I'll arrange an explanation; asking about an item isn't approval to proceed.

08 • Customer: That's helpful. My question is what the recommendation means, not when to start it.

09 • Advisor: I'll pass that question to the technician and leave B's authorization status unchanged.

10 • Customer: Then we agree: A approved as quoted, B unapproved while I seek clarification.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An estimate revision needs explanation

A customer queries two differently dated estimates.

01 • Customer: I have an earlier estimate for two hundred dollars and a newer one for two forty.

02 • Advisor: The newer document includes a proposed additional line. It doesn't establish that you approved it.

03 • Customer: I approved the earlier scope. Please explain what changed before seeking another decision.

04 • Advisor: I'll compare the two versions and identify that added line for your review.

05 • Customer: Does the revised total automatically replace the authorization limit from our earlier conversation?

06 • Advisor: No. We need to clarify the proposed change and your actual decision under the shop's terms.

07 • Customer: Then don't describe my request for an explanation as refusal of every service item.

08 • Advisor: I won't. Your earlier approval and the new proposal are separate parts of this record.

09 • Customer: Please give me the explanation with both dates so I can follow the comparison.

10 • Advisor: I'll arrange that now and preserve the additional line as pending your decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining estimates and approval limits

Fictional shop offers assessment for \$95 under its stated booking terms. No repair is included. Customer says 'go ahead' but intends only the assessment. Advisor must read back the scope and route any later repair proposal for separate approval.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: approve only the \$95 assessment; ask for a separate repair explanation before deciding.

Second round: Customer sets a contact preference but does not approve repairs. Keep contact permission separate from work authorization.

Scenario 2 | An amount without an agreed task

Customer says 'up to \$200 is okay' while discussing two different assessments. No scope is selected yet.

Role A: Advisor: ask which assessment the customer means.

Role B: Customer: intend the cabin-noise assessment only; exclude the separate display concern.

Possible opening: Which specific assessment does that amount apply to?

Success checks

- Attach amount to a named assessment.
- Exclude the other concern from this approval.
- Read back the scope before recording the decision.

Add a complication: Another staff member interprets the amount as permission for any work.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Handing the concern to the technician

Give a technician a usable handoff without inserting a diagnosis.

SITUATION

Job card 208 concerns a customer-reported intermittent cabin rattle after overnight parking. Customer approved assessment only, is unavailable from 12:00 to 14:00, and prefers a phone call after 14:00. Technician has not reproduced the concern. Advisor hands over these facts without a diagnosis.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

job card - The workshop record identifying the assigned vehicle, work scope, and relevant job details.

reported condition - A circumstance described by the customer that has not necessarily been independently observed.

technician finding - An observation or assessment actually made and recorded by the technician.

carryover job - A service job remaining incomplete when it passes to another work period or colleague.

Useful word combinations

hand over the job card: transfer the current scope and concern

attribute the reported condition: identify the customer's account

separate a finding from a report: distinguish technician evidence

read back the work scope: confirm the agreed task before handoff

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Preserve source, scope, and contact constraints

3. Notice the language

A job card should distinguish what the customer said from what the technician observed.

The customer reports ___ under ___.

The approved scope is ___.

Their contact restriction is ___; findings are ___.

Compare this wording: The technician found the rattle already.

Clearer: The customer reported the rattle; the technician has not yet reproduced it.

The wording preserves the actual source of information.

4. Check the language

1. Technician: Was the noise confirmed by another technician?

Advisor: No; it is customer-___.

- A. resolved
- B. repaired
- C. reported
- D. replaced

2. Technician: Did someone establish the 'faulty speaker' written on the job card?

Advisor: No. It is ___; the customer only suggested it.

- A. a confirmed technician finding
- B. an approved repair instruction
- C. an unverified customer hypothesis
- D. a completed diagnostic conclusion

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Job card 208

An advisor hands an assessment-only job to a technician.

01 • Advisor: Job card two oh eight is assessment only for a reported intermittent cabin rattle.

02 • Technician: Has another technician reproduced it, or is the description entirely from the customer?

03 • Advisor: It is customer-reported after overnight parking; no technician finding is recorded yet.

04 • Technician: I'll keep that report distinct from whatever this assessment actually establishes or doesn't establish.

05 • Advisor: The customer is unavailable from noon to two and prefers a call afterward.

06 • Technician: Thanks. Any additional work proposal should go through the service desk for discussion.

07 • Advisor: Correct. Their contact preference doesn't extend the currently agreed scope on this job.

08 • Technician: Does the previous repair order concern the same symptom or a different visit?

09 • Advisor: It concerns a display issue; don't merge that history with today's reported rattle.

10 • Technician: I have the scope, source, and contact window. I'll return findings against this job card.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A coolant observation in a carryover job

A technician hands a stated finding to the incoming service advisor without prescribing work.

01 • Technician: This carryover job includes my recorded coolant observation, but no repair is approved.

02 • Advisor: Please distinguish your actual finding from the customer's original report before I call them.

03 • Technician: The customer reported a visible mark. My note records coolant residue at the inspected location.

04 • Advisor: Has that established a particular faulty component, or does the cause remain unconfirmed?

05 • Technician: No component fault is confirmed. Please relay the observation without adding a repair recommendation.

06 • Advisor: I can explain that coolant is fluid used in the vehicle's cooling system.

07 • Technician: Yes, but refer the observation's significance to me; don't advise the customer on handling it.

08 • Advisor: I'll keep the technical explanation separate from any proposed additional work or charge.

09 • Technician: The service desk owns the callback. No completion estimate has been confirmed for this carryover.

10 • Advisor: I'll report the stated finding and ask you to explain the remaining uncertainty directly.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The customer's hypothesis was copied as a finding

An advisor corrects a job-card wording error with a technician.

01 • Advisor: The job card says faulty speaker, but that was the customer's suggestion, not a finding.

02 • Technician: Thanks for flagging it. What did the customer actually report experiencing in the vehicle?

03 • Advisor: An occasional buzz near the door. They wondered whether the speaker might be involved.

04 • Technician: Then the symptom description is the buzz; the speaker explanation remains their unverified hypothesis.

05 • Advisor: I'll correct the source wording and retain both pieces without treating the suggestion as established.

06 • Technician: Please notify the service desk too, since they may have seen the stronger wording already.

07 • Advisor: I will. Updating the card doesn't guarantee earlier readers know the claim was corrected.

08 • Technician: Exactly. We need the handoff to distinguish customer-reported condition from technician finding.

09 • Advisor: No assessment result exists yet. I'll make that explicit in the corrected message.

10 • Technician: That gives me an accurate starting point without presupposing a cause for the reported sound.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handing the concern to the technician

Job card 208 concerns a customer-reported intermittent cabin rattle after overnight parking. Customer approved assessment only, is unavailable from 12:00 to 14:00, and prefers a phone call after 14:00. Technician has not reproduced the concern. Advisor hands over these facts without a diagnosis.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Technician: repeat assessment-only scope and the customer's contact window.

Second round: A previous job card lists a different concern. Keep that history distinct from the current customer report.

Scenario 2 | A report from another workshop

Customer brings a note from another workshop stating 'review requested.' Reception labels it a confirmed fault. Current technician has not assessed the vehicle.

Role A: Advisor: distinguish the external note from a confirmed finding.

Role B: Technician: ask for the note's exact wording and source.

Possible opening: Does the note report a finding, or request a review?

Success checks

- Preserve exact note meaning.
- Attribute its external source.
- Leave today's findings unconfirmed.

Add a complication: Someone wants to copy the presumed diagnosis into today's job card.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining parts and completion delays

Give parts status without turning a supplier estimate into a collection promise.

SITUATION

Part for job 315 is on back order. Supplier estimates Tuesday arrival; shipment is not confirmed. Customer wants Tuesday pickup. Technician scheduling and completion remain unconfirmed. Parts clerk promises a supply-status update Monday afternoon.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

back order - An order for a part that cannot currently be supplied from available stock.

estimated delivery date - The supplier's predicted arrival date, not confirmation that a part has arrived.

battery terminal - A battery's electrical connection point linking it with the vehicle's electrical circuit.

completion estimate - The currently expected time when agreed work may finish, subject to stated dependencies.

Useful word combinations

check parts availability: verify supply of the specified item

update the completion estimate: revise expected finish timing

separate arrival from installation: distinguish supply from completed work

explain a back order: state the supply constraint without blaming

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Explain the dependency behind a delay

3. Notice the language

Part arrival, technical work, and vehicle readiness are separate stages.

The part is ____; the supplier estimates ____.

That date refers to ____, not ____.

Our next status update is ____.

Compare this wording: Your car will be ready when the part arrives.

Clearer: The part's arrival is estimated; the completion time still needs review.

The revision preserves the work remaining after supply.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Is Tuesday the pickup date?

Advisor: It is the estimated part ____ date.

A. completion

B. collection

C. approval

D. delivery

2. Parts clerk: Has the item shipped?

Advisor: Shipment is still ____; we only have an estimate.

A. unconfirmed

B. received

C. completed

D. confirmed

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Tuesday is the part estimate

An advisor updates a customer about job 315.

01 • Advisor: The part for job three fifteen is on back order, with Tuesday estimated by the supplier.

02 • Customer: Does that mean I can collect the car Tuesday afternoon once it arrives?

03 • Advisor: No. Tuesday describes estimated parts delivery, not confirmed arrival or completed vehicle work.

04 • Customer: I need transport arrangements, so please don't leave the distinction hidden in the update.

05 • Advisor: The parts desk will give us another supply-status update Monday afternoon, even if availability remains uncertain.

06 • Customer: After that, can the service team review the completion estimate using the confirmed information?

07 • Advisor: Yes. They'll need supply status and workshop scheduling before giving a supported completion estimate.

08 • Customer: Then I should treat Tuesday pickup as unconfirmed rather than reserve a ride around it.

09 • Advisor: Correct. I'll keep the part estimate, next update, and vehicle readiness as separate stages.

10 • Customer: Thank you. A clear uncertainty is more useful than an arrival date presented as a pickup promise.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A label exists, but dispatch is unconfirmed

A parts clerk clarifies shipment evidence with an advisor.

01 • Advisor: The tracking page shows a label created. Can I tell the customer the part has shipped?

02 • Parts clerk: Not from that status alone. We haven't confirmed that the carrier received the actual package.

03 • Advisor: Then label creation is a preparation event, not proof of the supplier's dispatch?

04 • Parts clerk: Exactly. I'll ask for shipment confirmation and keep the estimated delivery date qualified.

05 • Advisor: The customer already knows a part was ordered; they need the current supply stage.

06 • Parts clerk: You can say ordered, tracking label created, carrier possession not yet confirmed.

07 • Advisor: I'll avoid calling it in transit until the tracking or supplier confirms that movement.

08 • Parts clerk: Please do. The completion estimate also remains dependent on arrival and the remaining workshop schedule.

09 • Advisor: Can you send the confirmed update to the service desk once the supplier responds?

10 • Parts clerk: Yes. I'll identify the part request and actual shipment status, not just forward an unexplained tracking number.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

One part available, another pending

An advisor and parts clerk clarify a mixed supply status.

01 • Advisor: The parts request names a battery terminal and a separate cover. Are both available?

02 • Parts clerk: Only the battery terminal, P1, is available. The cover, P2, awaits the supplier's response.

03 • Advisor: Then saying the parts are here would overstate the status of the whole job.

04 • Parts clerk: Correct. We need to identify each item rather than apply P1's status to both.

05 • Advisor: Is P2 confirmed as a back order, or is parts availability simply unconfirmed?

06 • Parts clerk: Availability is unconfirmed. We don't yet have evidence for the more specific back-order status.

07 • Advisor: I'll tell the customer one item is available and the second supply check remains pending.

08 • Parts clerk: That is accurate. Don't infer a completion date from the availability of only P1.

09 • Advisor: Please let the workshop know the same distinction so scheduling uses the actual supply status.

10 • Parts clerk: I'll send an item-specific update with P1 available and P2 awaiting the supplier's answer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining parts and completion delays

Part for job 315 is on back order. Supplier estimates Tuesday arrival; shipment is not confirmed. Customer wants Tuesday pickup. Technician scheduling and completion remain unconfirmed. Parts clerk promises a supply-status update Monday afternoon.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: Tuesday pickup matters, but you need an honest update about the supply dependency.

Second round: A tracking label is created without confirmed carrier possession. Avoid reporting actual shipment from label creation alone.

Scenario 2 | The supplier updates only one date

Supplier moves estimated part arrival from Wednesday to Thursday. No vehicle completion date was confirmed. Customer believes a Wednesday pickup was canceled.

Role A: Advisor: explain which estimate changed.

Role B: Customer: ask for the next supply update and avoid assuming a new pickup date.

Possible opening: Was Wednesday the part estimate or a confirmed vehicle collection?

Success checks

- Identify the parts estimate change.
- Keep collection unconfirmed.
- Agree the next status communication.

Add a complication: Customer treats Thursday arrival as Thursday completion.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Relaying findings and technical terms

Explain technical terms and the limits of a technician's stated findings.

SITUATION

A technician's assessment note records a diagnostic trouble code, or DTC, but no confirmed cause or component fault. Customer assumes it proves a sensor needs replacement. Advisor must relay the limited finding and request a technician explanation; no replacement is approved.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

brake pad - The friction-material component that presses against a brake disc in a disc-brake assembly; condition assessment belongs to a qualified technician.

brake disc - The rotating disc, also called a rotor, against which brake pads act in a disc-brake system.

tread depth - The measured depth of the grooves in a tire's tread; interpretation depends on the applicable technical and local requirements.

diagnostic trouble code - A code stored by a vehicle's diagnostic system indicating a monitored condition for investigation, often shortened to DTC; it does not by itself prove a particular component has failed.

Useful word combinations

relay a brake-pad finding: attribute the condition report to the technician

identify the brake disc: explain that disc and rotor can name the same component

quote a tread-depth measurement: preserve the technician's stated value and unit without inventing an assessment

distinguish a code from a diagnosis: explain that a recorded DTC does not alone prove component failure

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Distinguish recorded findings from conclusions

3. Notice the language

Attribute findings to the qualified technician. A diagnostic trouble code records a monitored condition, not automatic proof of a failed component. Likewise, not reproduced limits an assessment result without dismissing the customer's account.

The technician recorded ___, but has not confirmed ___.

In this note, ___ refers to ___.

Please ask the technician to explain the significance before ___.

Compare this wording: That code proves the sensor needs replacing.

Clearer: A code was recorded; a failed sensor has not been confirmed by the technician.

The correction separates diagnostic information from a conclusion that the report does not support.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: The report records a DTC but gives no confirmed cause. Does it prove the sensor failed?

Advisor: No. It is ___, not a confirmed component diagnosis.

- A. a completed repair
- B. a recorded diagnostic trouble code
- C. a reproduced customer symptom
- D. an approved replacement

2. Customer: Is a recommendation already approved work?

Advisor: No; it is a ___ for discussion.

- A. receipt
- B. finding of approval
- C. proposal
- D. completion

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Not reproduced is a limited finding

An advisor explains a technician's assessment outcome.

01 • Customer: The report says not reproduced. Are you saying I imagined the rattle?

02 • Advisor: No. The technician didn't reproduce it during this assessment; that doesn't invalidate your report.

03 • Customer: So you haven't confirmed that nothing is wrong under every possible condition?

04 • Advisor: Correct. The cause remains unconfirmed, and I shouldn't turn this finding into a broader guarantee.

05 • Customer: I'd like someone to explain what the finding means before we discuss further options.

06 • Advisor: I can arrange a technician explanation and preserve your question on the repair order.

07 • Customer: Please don't record my request as approval for another assessment or a repair.

08 • Advisor: I won't. Asking for an explanation is separate from deciding on additional work.

09 • Customer: And can reception tell me whether the car is safe to drive now?

10 • Advisor: That question needs the qualified technician's response; I can't provide a safety assurance myself.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A recommendation needs an explanation

A customer asks an advisor about a technical recommendation.

01 • Customer: The report recommends further assessment, but the brief message doesn't explain the reason.

02 • Advisor: I can ask the technician to explain the finding behind that recommendation in plain language.

03 • Customer: Please separate what they observed from what they are proposing to do next.

04 • Advisor: I will. An inspection finding and a recommendation serve different purposes in the report.

05 • Customer: Does the recommendation mean additional work has already been approved on my behalf?

06 • Advisor: No. It remains a proposal for discussion, with scope and terms to be clarified.

07 • Customer: I want to understand those details before deciding, not reject everything automatically.

08 • Advisor: I'll preserve that position: explanation requested, decision pending, no new authorization assumed.

09 • Customer: Could the technician also clarify any unfamiliar term rather than just repeat it louder?

10 • Advisor: Yes. I'll ask for an explanation tied to your actual finding and proposed options.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A stored code is not a failed component

An advisor clarifies the limits of a technician's recorded diagnostic trouble code.

- 01 • Customer:** The report shows a diagnostic trouble code. Does that prove a sensor failed?
- 02 • Advisor:** No. The technician recorded the code, but hasn't confirmed its underlying cause.
- 03 • Customer:** I thought a DTC named the exact part that definitely needed replacing.
- 04 • Advisor:** A diagnostic trouble code indicates a monitored condition for investigation, not automatic component failure.
- 05 • Customer:** Then please don't describe my question as permission to replace a sensor.
- 06 • Advisor:** I won't. No replacement is approved, and the technician needs to explain this finding.
- 07 • Customer:** Can they distinguish the stored code from anything actually reproduced during the assessment?
- 08 • Advisor:** I'll ask for that distinction and any proposed next step, with its scope explained.
- 09 • Customer:** Please link the explanation to my current report rather than a generic list of codes.
- 10 • Advisor:** I will. Your code finding and any later diagnosis will remain separately identified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Relaying findings and technical terms

A technician's assessment note records a diagnostic trouble code, or DTC, but no confirmed cause or component fault. Customer assumes it proves a sensor needs replacement. Advisor must relay the limited finding and request a technician explanation; no replacement is approved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: the report mentions a stored code; ask whether that proves a sensor failure and what remains unconfirmed.

Second round: The customer sees rotor on the report and brake disc in a message. Explain the naming equivalence without claiming its condition or approving replacement.

Scenario 2 | A shorthand phrase confuses the customer

Technician note says 'further review recommended.' Customer reads it as a failed inspection. Advisor has no result beyond that exact note.

Role A: Advisor: distinguish recommendation from a confirmed failed result.

Role B: Customer: request a technician explanation before deciding.

Possible opening: Does the note state a failure, or recommend another review?

Success checks

- Relay only the stated finding.
- Seek a qualified explanation.
- Do not infer diagnosis or approval.

Add a complication: Customer asks reception to interpret the technical cause.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying the invoice and collection handoff

Clarify charge categories and separate billing from vehicle release.

SITUATION

Fictional invoice totals \$180: \$70 parts and \$110 labor. Customer thinks labor includes another \$70 part charge. Vehicle readiness has not yet been confirmed by the service desk; invoice creation alone is not collection confirmation.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

itemized invoice - A bill separating the individual work, parts, and other stated charges.

labor charge - The invoice amount for the workshop work described, distinct from the listed parts charge.

collection confirmation - A message confirming the vehicle is ready for collection under the service arrangement.

authorized collector - A person whose permission to collect the vehicle has been confirmed under the shop's requirements.

Useful word combinations

review the itemized invoice: explain the listed lines without inventing charges

distinguish parts from labor: identify separate cost categories

confirm collection readiness: verify the actual release status

check the authorized collector: follow the shop's identity and permission requirements

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Explain the bill without overstating readiness

3. Notice the language

Use the stated fictional invoice, not assumptions about shop rates, tax rules, or universal charges.

The invoice separates ___ from ___.

These listed amounts total ___.

Collection readiness still needs ___.

Compare this wording: The invoice means you can collect now.

Clearer: The invoice is available; vehicle readiness is a separate confirmation.

A billing record is not automatic release evidence.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Does labor mean another parts charge?

Advisor: No; these are ___ invoice categories.

A. identical

B. interchangeable

C. duplicated

D. separate

2. Customer: Is the invoice a ready-to-collect message?

Advisor: No; collection still needs ___.

A. confirmation

B. quotation

C. estimation

D. recommendation

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Parts and labor are separate lines

An advisor explains a fictional \$180 invoice.

01 • Customer: The invoice lists seventy for parts and one hundred ten for labor. Is seventy charged twice?

02 • Advisor: No. The seventy-dollar parts line and one-hundred-ten-dollar labor charge total one hundred eighty.

03 • Customer: Thank you. I read the headings too quickly and combined them incorrectly.

04 • Advisor: I can walk through the itemized invoice using the actual descriptions shown here.

05 • Customer: Since the invoice is available, can I come and collect the vehicle immediately?

06 • Advisor: Not yet on that basis. The service desk still needs to confirm collection readiness.

07 • Customer: So billing information and the ready-to-collect message are separate confirmations in this case?

08 • Advisor: Exactly. I'll ask for the actual vehicle status rather than infer it from the bill.

09 • Customer: Please call me when that status is confirmed, so I can arrange my ride.

10 • Advisor: I'll record your call preference and keep the collection question open until the desk responds.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A friend offers to collect

A customer asks reception about a different collector.

01 • Customer: My friend can collect the car. Is giving them a copy of the invoice enough?

02 • Receptionist: The invoice alone doesn't establish an authorized collector under this shop's collection requirements.

03 • Customer: Then please explain what the service desk needs to confirm my collection arrangement.

04 • Receptionist: I'll connect you with them so the identity and permission details are checked appropriately.

05 • Customer: Please don't change the owner details on the account; I'm only asking about collection.

06 • Receptionist: Understood. Collector permission and the vehicle's account information are different parts of the record.

07 • Customer: Has the vehicle already been confirmed ready, or are we arranging collection in advance?

08 • Receptionist: The ready-to-collect confirmation is still pending. Your collector question doesn't change that status.

09 • Customer: Then my friend should wait for both the arrangement and readiness confirmation before traveling.

10 • Receptionist: Correct. I'll pass both outstanding questions to the desk without treating either as settled.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A receipt and an invoice are different records

A customer clarifies two service documents with an advisor.

01 • Customer: This document says invoice. Does that prove the payment has already been received?

02 • Advisor: Not by its title alone. Let me check the payment status separately from the listed charges.

03 • Customer: I don't want to make a second payment because I misunderstood which document I received.

04 • Advisor: The account shows payment received, and the receipt reference is linked to this invoice.

05 • Customer: Then please identify that receipt so I can keep the records together.

06 • Advisor: Here is the matching reference. It confirms the recorded payment rather than adding another charge.

07 • Customer: Does that payment record also confirm every service item I asked about was performed?

08 • Advisor: No. Work performed is described on the completed job record; payment doesn't expand its scope.

09 • Customer: I'll compare those records rather than assume all my earlier questions became completed work.

10 • Advisor: I can help identify the relevant lines and refer any technical completion question to the technician.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying the invoice and collection handoff

Fictional invoice totals \$180: \$70 parts and \$110 labor. Customer thinks labor includes another \$70 part charge. Vehicle readiness has not yet been confirmed by the service desk; invoice creation alone is not collection confirmation.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you misread parts and labor; ask whether you may collect immediately.

Second round: A friend offers to collect. Do not infer permission from possession of an invoice; refer to the shop's collection requirements.

Scenario 2 | The ready message names the other car

Household account has two vehicles. Ready message references the sedan; customer asks to collect the hatchback, whose status is unconfirmed.

Role A: Advisor: match the message to its actual vehicle.

Role B: Customer: provide both bookings; do not infer hatchback readiness.

Possible opening: Which vehicle and repair order does the ready message name?

Success checks

- Confirm the sedan reference.
- Keep hatchback readiness separate.
- Check the hatchback's service status.

Add a complication: Customer assumes one message covers both household cars.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Handling a repeat concern and follow-up

Acknowledge the customer's report and repair an unsupported claim.

SITUATION

Customer calls two days after service, reporting the same intermittent rattle. Advisor initially said 'that cannot be the same issue.' Cause and warranty coverage are unknown. Service lead Nia can call at 15:00 to review the report and next arrangements.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

repeat visit - A return to the service business about a continuing or recurring concern.

callback request - A request for a service-team member to contact the customer again.

warranty inquiry - A question about whether stated warranty terms apply, not a confirmed coverage decision.

case reference - The identifier used to link messages, visits, and review activity concerning an issue.

Useful word combinations

acknowledge a repeat concern: recognize the customer's ongoing experience

link the previous repair order: connect relevant history without assuming cause

refer a warranty inquiry: seek review of the applicable terms

confirm callback ownership: identify who will respond and when

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Correct a dismissive response

3. Notice the language

A repeat symptom does not prove the same cause, a failed repair, or warranty coverage. It deserves a factual review.

I spoke too definitively when I said ____.

You report ____ again; we need to review ____.

____ will call at ____ to discuss ____.

Compare this wording: That can't happen after our work.

Clearer: You have reported the concern again; we'll review it alongside the earlier job.

The revision removes an unsupported denial without inventing a cause.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Are you saying the repair definitely failed?

Advisor: No; the cause remains ____.

A. completed

B. confirmed

C. replaced

D. unconfirmed

2. Customer: Does the callback approve warranty coverage?

Advisor: No; it arranges a ____ of your inquiry.

A. review

B. guarantee

C. payment

D. replacement

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correcting an overconfident denial

An advisor repairs an earlier response to a repeat concern.

01 • Advisor: I spoke too definitively when I said it couldn't be the same issue.

02 • Customer: I heard the rattle again two days after service. I need that taken seriously.

03 • Advisor: We'll review your report alongside the earlier repair order without assuming its cause.

04 • Customer: Are you promising the next visit is covered by warranty, or is that undecided?

05 • Advisor: Coverage is unconfirmed. Nia can call at three to discuss the report and next arrangements.

06 • Customer: Please don't treat my warranty inquiry as proof that the earlier work failed.

07 • Advisor: I won't. A recurring symptom, its cause, and applicable coverage need separate review.

08 • Customer: Can the callback use the same case reference so I don't repeat everything?

09 • Advisor: Yes. I'll link the previous visit and today's report for Nia's callback.

10 • Customer: Thank you. That corrects the earlier dismissal without making a new unsupported promise.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The same symptom may have a different cause

A service advisor takes a repeat-visit inquiry.

01 • Customer: The display went blank again. Does that prove the same component failed twice?

02 • Advisor: I can't establish that from the symptom alone. The technician needs to review the recurrence.

03 • Customer: Please connect this call with last month's repair order so the history is available.

04 • Advisor: I will. I'll record your new report with today's date and the earlier reference.

05 • Customer: I'd also like someone to explain whether any warranty terms apply to this concern.

06 • Advisor: I can refer that warranty inquiry, but I can't confirm coverage before review.

07 • Customer: Does asking the question automatically book another assessment or approve a diagnostic charge?

08 • Advisor: No. We need to discuss any proposed appointment, scope, and terms separately.

09 • Customer: Then for now I'm requesting a callback, not approving a new job.

10 • Advisor: I've recorded that accurately and will ask the service desk to confirm the callback arrangement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A missed callback gets a concrete repair

A customer asks about a promised service response.

01 • Customer: I was promised a callback yesterday afternoon, but I didn't receive one.

02 • Advisor: I'm sorry we missed that contact commitment. Let me check the actual case status.

03 • Customer: Please don't tell me the technical review is complete unless someone has confirmed it.

04 • Advisor: The review remains pending. Our missed call and the unresolved assessment are separate issues.

05 • Customer: I need a named contact rather than another vague promise that someone will respond.

06 • Advisor: Service lead Omar has accepted the callback for four today using this case reference.

07 • Customer: Will that be a status update even if the technical review is still unfinished?

08 • Advisor: Yes. He will explain the current status, not guarantee a conclusion by four.

09 • Customer: Thank you. Please include that I prefer a call, because I may miss a text.

10 • Advisor: I've confirmed the phone preference and Omar's ownership of the four-o'clock callback.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handling a repeat concern and follow-up

Customer calls two days after service, reporting the same intermittent rattle. Advisor initially said 'that cannot be the same issue.' Cause and warranty coverage are unknown. Service lead Nia can call at 15:00 to review the report and next arrangements.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: the rattle recurred; ask to be heard and linked to the previous visit.

Second round: Customer demands a no-cost outcome before review. Acknowledge the concern and refer the charge or coverage decision without a promise.

Scenario 2 | A callback recorded as a booked repair

Customer requests a Friday call about a repeat concern. Record incorrectly says repair booked Friday. No appointment or work approval exists.

Role A: Advisor: correct the contact-versus-work confusion.

Role B: Customer: confirm a Friday call only; review options before deciding.

Possible opening: You requested a call Friday, not a repair appointment, correct?

Success checks

- Correct the booking claim.
- Notify anyone relying on it.
- Preserve the callback without inventing work approval.

Add a complication: A colleague promises completion Friday based on the mistaken entry.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Capturing the customer's concern

Editing example: You report an occasional rear rattle after overnight parking; the cause is unconfirmed.

The revised description preserves the symptom without inventing a fault.

Check 1: B - intermittent

A: Continuous means ongoing, which contradicts some mornings.

B: Correct. Intermittent means it occurs only sometimes.

C: The customer has not reported a resolution.

D: No technician has yet reproduced the concern.

Check 2: D - current repair order

A: An inspection finding would imply a technician's assessment.

B: Describing a symptom does not define an approved repair scope.

C: No diagnosis supports requesting a replacement part at this stage.

D: Correct. The repair order can preserve the reported concern.

Model response: Let me confirm that this concern is for the blue hatchback, not the other car on your account. You hear an occasional rear rattle after the car has been parked overnight. Have I captured that accurately? I'll record your description for the technician without naming a faulty component before an assessment.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Clarifying the appointment and drop-off

Editing example: Eight is intake; a technician start time has not been confirmed.

The revision explains exactly what the appointment establishes.

Check 1: B - drop-off intake

A: No assessment result is confirmed at intake.

B: Correct. The booked time is for reception intake.

C: The booking says nothing about parts arrival.

D: Completion has not been promised at eight.

Check 2: C - contact preference

A: The request concerns contact method, not a guaranteed finish.

B: No technical assessment result was provided by this request.

C: Correct. A call preference changes communication, not work approval.

D: The customer explicitly has not made a repair decision.

Model response: Eight o'clock is your drop-off appointment for intake; it isn't a confirmed technician start or finish time. I understand you were expecting the car back by nine. We can give you a phone update by ten about the assessment status. Before you decide about the visit, let's make that difference in timing clear.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Explaining estimates and approval limits

Editing example: You approved the stated assessment only; repairs would need a separate decision.

The read-back ties agreement to the customer's intended scope.

Check 1: B - limited

A: Converted does not express the required scope boundary.

B: Correct. Limited preserves the customer's stated boundary.

C: Extended would enlarge the scope they approved.

D: Unrelated would disconnect approval from the task.

Check 2: B - assessment

A: No completed repair is included in the assessment.

B: Correct. The stated charge is for assessment only.

C: Replacement work is not included in this scope.

D: Installation work is not part of this booking.

Model response: To confirm, your approval is for the ninety-five-dollar assessment described in this booking, not for a repair or additional work. If the technician recommends something beyond that scope, we'll explain the proposal and seek a separate decision under the shop's terms. Is that the authorization you intend to give?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Handing the concern to the technician

Editing example: The customer reported the rattle; the technician has not yet reproduced it.

The wording preserves the actual source of information.

Check 1: C - reported

A: Resolved would imply the concern ended.

B: Repaired would imply completed technical work.

C: Correct. The customer is the source of this account.

D: Replaced describes an item change, not a report.

Check 2: C - an unverified customer hypothesis

A: No technician has established the proposed speaker fault.

B: The suggestion is not permission to carry out a repair.

C: Correct. The explanation is the customer's unconfirmed suggestion.

D: No completed assessment supports that diagnostic conclusion.

Model response: Job card 208 is assessment only. The customer reports an intermittent cabin rattle after overnight parking; no technician finding is recorded yet. They are unavailable from noon to two and prefer a call afterward. Please keep their report separate from your findings and return any proposed additional work to the service desk for discussion.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Explaining parts and completion delays

Editing example: The part's arrival is estimated; the completion time still needs review.

The revision preserves the work remaining after supply.

Check 1: D - delivery

A: The vehicle's work is not confirmed complete then.

B: Customer collection is not what the supplier estimates.

C: No approval date is being described.

D: Correct. The estimate concerns the part arriving.

Check 2: A - unconfirmed

A: Correct. An estimate does not confirm dispatch.

B: Receipt would occur after an actual shipment.

C: Completed overstates the current supply evidence.

D: The scenario explicitly lacks shipment confirmation.

Model response: The part for job 315 is on back order. Tuesday is the supplier's estimated delivery date, not a confirmed arrival or vehicle collection time. The parts desk will update us Monday afternoon. Once supply is confirmed, the service team can review the completion estimate; I can't promise Tuesday pickup on the information we have.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Relaying findings and technical terms

Editing example: A code was recorded; a failed sensor has not been confirmed by the technician.

The correction separates diagnostic information from a conclusion that the report does not support.

Check 1: B - a recorded diagnostic trouble code

A: The code does not establish any completed repair.

B: Correct. The code is recorded information requiring interpretation.

C: A stored code does not establish that the symptom was reproduced.

D: No replacement approval appears in the stated report.

Check 2: C - proposal

A: A receipt records an event or payment.

B: No approval has been established by recommending work.

C: Correct. A recommendation proposes rather than authorizes work.

D: Completion would mean the work is already finished.

Model response: The technician recorded a diagnostic trouble code, but the note does not confirm a failed sensor or a required replacement. A stored code is information for assessment, not a component diagnosis by itself. I'll ask the technician to explain this finding and any proposed next step before you consider additional work.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Clarifying the invoice and collection handoff

Editing example: The invoice is available; vehicle readiness is a separate confirmation.

A billing record is not automatic release evidence.

Check 1: D - separate

A: They refer to different kinds of charges.

B: One category does not replace the other.

C: No duplicated charge is established in this invoice.

D: Correct. Parts and labor are distinct categories.

Check 2: A - confirmation

A: Correct. The service desk must confirm the collection status.

B: A quotation concerns proposed pricing rather than readiness.

C: An estimate would not establish actual readiness.

D: A recommendation does not establish readiness either.

Model response: This invoice separates seventy dollars for parts from one hundred ten dollars for labor, giving a total of one hundred eighty dollars. The labor line is not another seventy-dollar parts charge. I can clarify those categories now, but the invoice's availability doesn't itself confirm collection readiness; the service desk still needs to confirm that status.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Handling a repeat concern and follow-up

Editing example: You have reported the concern again; we'll review it alongside the earlier job.

The revision removes an unsupported denial without inventing a cause.

Check 1: D - unconfirmed

A: Completion does not describe an unknown cause.

B: No technical review has established the cause.

C: Replacement is an action, not the evidence status.

D: Correct. The cause has not yet been established.

Check 2: A - review

A: Correct. A review considers the inquiry without deciding it.

B: The callback is not a coverage guarantee.

C: No payment decision has been confirmed here.

D: No replacement has been approved by this call.

Model response: I spoke too definitively when I said it couldn't be the same issue. You've reported the rattle again, and we need to review that account alongside the earlier repair order. Nia can call at three to discuss the next arrangements. I can't yet identify the cause or confirm whether any warranty terms apply.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All vehicles, people, prices, incidents, findings, and shop arrangements are fictional English practice, not automotive diagnosis, repair instruction, driving advice, legal advice, or financial guidance. No script establishes vehicle safety or universal rights, charges, warranty terms, or authorization rules. Refer technical assessments, safe-use questions, hazardous conditions, pricing decisions, warranty coverage, and release requirements to the responsible qualified people and applicable local arrangements.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Automotive Service Technicians and Mechanics

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/installation-maintenance-and-repair/automotive-service-technicians-and-mechanics.htm>

Federal Trade Commission: Auto Repair Basics, repair information and customer questions

<https://consumer.ftc.gov/articles/0211-auto-repair-basics>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Automotive Service English

Professional audience: Service reception staff, service advisors, automotive technicians, parts-counter staff, and workshop assistants

Scope: All vehicles, people, prices, incidents, findings, and shop arrangements are fictional English practice, not automotive diagnosis, repair instruction, driving advice, legal advice, or financial guidance. No script establishes vehicle safety or universal rights, charges, warranty terms, or authorization rules. Refer technical assessments, safe-use questions, hazardous conditions, pricing decisions, warranty coverage, and release requirements to the responsible qualified people and applicable local arrangements.

Lesson 01: Capturing the customer's concern

Original fictional case: Customer reports an occasional rattle from the rear after the car has been parked overnight. They do not know its cause. Two household cars are on the account; today's booking is the blue hatchback. No technician assessment has occurred.

Language workshop: Record the concern without rewriting it as a diagnosis

Communication goal: Clarify vehicle identity and reported circumstances.

Language guidance: Customer descriptions guide the handoff but do not establish a mechanical cause.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Which vehicle does this concern relate to? / You notice ___ when ___; is that accurate? / I'll record ___ as reported, with the cause unconfirmed.

Vocabulary: repair order: The job record linking a vehicle, customer concern, agreed work, and service results. / intermittent concern: A reported problem that occurs sometimes rather than continuously. /

symptom description: The customer's account of what they noticed, without a confirmed explanation of cause. / vehicle identification number: The vehicle's unique identifying code, commonly shortened to VIN.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: the blue hatchback rattles on some mornings after overnight parking; you cannot identify a component.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: Customer suggests a component name from an online video. Record it as their suggestion, not a diagnosis.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Let me confirm that this concern is for the blue hatchback, not the other car on your account. You hear an occasional rear rattle after the car has been parked overnight. Have I captured that accurately? I'll record your description for the technician without naming a faulty component before an assessment.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT